

Theorem. $\mathbb{R}$ is an ordered field with the Least Upper Bound Property

Proof. **Part 1: $\mathbb{R}$ is an ordered field.**

For $\mathbb{R}$ to be an ordered field, it must be a field, it must be an ordered set, and it must satisfy the following:

- (i) For all a, b , and c in $\mathbb{R}$, if $a < b$, then $a + c < b + c$.
- (ii) If $a \leq b$ and $c \geq 0$, then $ac \leq bc$.

These are already a lot, and each of them can be expanded, so for organizational purposes, this will be organized as a nested list.

1. $\mathbb{R}$ is a Field

(a) Additive

- i. There is an element 0 in $\mathbb{R}$ such that $a + 0 = 0 + a = a$ for all a in $\mathbb{R}$.
- ii. Addition is associative: for any a, b , and c in $\mathbb{R}$, $a + (b + c) = (a + b) + c$, so $a + b + c$ is unambiguous.
- iii. Addition is commutative: for all a, b in $\mathbb{R}$, $a + b = b + a$.
- iv. Addition has inverses: for all a in $\mathbb{R}$, there exists some b in $\mathbb{R}$ such that $a + b = 0$. b is denoted as $-a$.

(b) Multiplicative

- i. There is an element 1 in $\mathbb{R}$ such that $a \cdot 1 = 1 \cdot a = a$ for all a in $\mathbb{R}$.
- ii. Multiplication is associative: for any a, b , and c in $\mathbb{R}$, $a \cdot (b \cdot c) = (a \cdot b) \cdot c$, so abc is unambiguous.
- iii. Multiplication is commutative: for all a, b in $\mathbb{R}$, $a \cdot b = b \cdot a$.
- iv. Multiplication has inverses: for all a in $\mathbb{R}$ such that $a \neq 0$, there exists some b in $\mathbb{R}$ such that $a \cdot b = 1$. b is denoted as a^{-1} .

(c) For all a, b , and c in $\mathbb{R}$, $a \cdot (b + c) = a \cdot b + a \cdot c$.

2. $\mathbb{R}$ is an ordered set: $\mathbb{R}$ has a relation $<$ such that:

- (a) Exactly one of $a < b$, $a = b$, and $b < a$ is true.
- (b) If $a < b$ and $b < c$, then $a < c$.

3. For all a, b , and c in $\mathbb{R}$, if $a < b$, then $a + c < b + c$.

4. If $a \leq b$ and $c \geq 0$, then $ac \leq bc$.

We can go through these one by one. Before we begin, recall the definition of the real numbers, that $\mathbb{R}$ is the set of cuts. A cut is a subset α of $\mathbb{Q}$ satisfying:

1. $\alpha \neq \emptyset$ and $\alpha \neq \mathbb{Q}$.
2. If p is in α and $q < p$, then q is in α .
3. If p is in α , then there exists some r in α such that $p < r$.

1.a.i: There is an element 0 in $\mathbb{R}$ such that $a + 0 = 0 + a = a$ for all a in $\mathbb{R}$.

Let's call the additive identity $0^{\star 1}$. We can also define the operation $+$ for cuts α and β .

$$\alpha + \beta = \{r + s : r \in \alpha, s \in \beta\} \quad (1)$$

In this case, we can set $\beta = 0^{\star}$.

$$\alpha + 0^{\star} = \{r + s : r \in \alpha, s \in 0^{\star}\} \quad (2)$$

Apply the associative property to the set definition.

$$\alpha + 0^{\star} = \{s + r : s \in 0^{\star}, r \in \alpha\} = 0^{\star} + \alpha \quad (3)$$

By the definition of the cuts, we can also make some statements about r and s .

1. For all s in $0^{\star}$, $s < 0$.
2. By the reflexive property, for all r in α , $r = r$.

Add both of these together.

$$r + s < r + 0 = r \quad (4)$$

Since for all r in α and s in $0^{\star}$, $r + s < r$. This means every $r + s$ in $\alpha + 0^{\star}$ is in α . This means that $\alpha \leq \alpha + 0^{\star}$.

In order to prove that $\alpha \geq \alpha + 0^{\star}$, we begin with some term p in $\alpha + 0^{\star}$, which is equal to the sum $r + s$ of terms r in α and s in $0^{\star}$. OE Δ

¹For any x , $x^{\star} = \{p \in \mathbb{Q} : p < x\}$